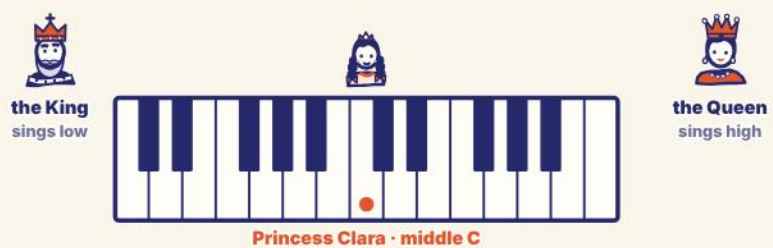
NOW (faces)

CHAPTER 4

Reading the Staff

Meet the royal family of the keys. The King sings low, the Queen sings high, and Princess Clara lives between them on middle C. This chapter writes their notes down, so your eyes can read what your hands play.



In this chapter

- [ ] Lines and spaces **page 2**
- [ ] Up the staff, up the piano **page 3**
- [ ] The Queen's five **page 4**
- [ ] The King's five **page 5**
- [ ] Middle C: Princess Clara **page 6**
- [ ] My five checks **page 7**

By the end, you can

- ✔ tell a line note from a space note
- ✔ see a step or a skip on the staff, and play it
- ✔ read C D E F G in the treble clef
- ✔ read F G A B C in the bass clef
- ✔ find middle C on both staves -- attached up or down, the same key

online

SAMPLE (crowns only)

Piano Butler · Lesson Book
Chapter 4 · Reading the Staff

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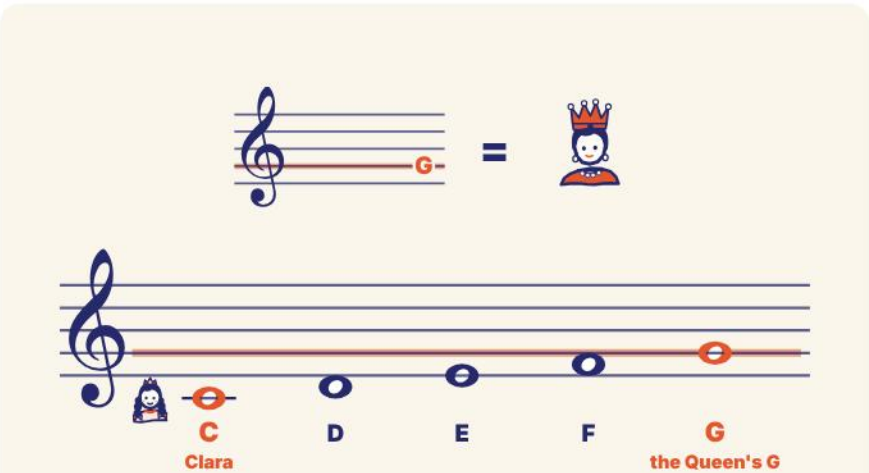
online

NOW (faces)

Step 3

The Queen's five

This curly sign is the **treble clef**. Long ago it was simply a letter **G**. Its curl wraps round the **second line** from the bottom, and that line is the **Queen's house**: every note on it is **G**. The Queen sings high, and usually the **right hand** reads her staff. From Princess Clara (middle C) up to the Queen's G is exactly **five notes**: C D E F G -- Clara on her little ladder rung under the staff, D just under line 1, E on line 1, F in space 1, G on the Queen's line.



At the piano

1. With your right hand, walk up from **middle C** to **G**: C D E F G -- looking at the staff picture, saying the letters. ☐
2. Someone points to one of the five: count down from the Queen's G or up from Clara's C, name it, play it. ☐
3. **Draw the Queen's curl:** a treble clef **starts on the G line** and spirals out -- it begins at the Queen's house! (The Workbook has one to trace.) ☐

REMEMBER **The curl wraps round G: the Queen's line. Clara to the Queen: C D E F G.**

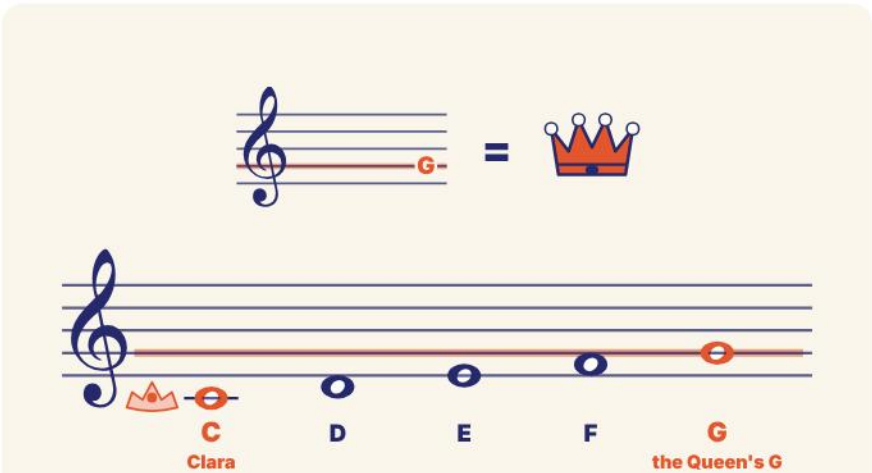
SAMPLE (crowns only)

Piano Butler · Lesson Book Chapter 4 · Reading the Staff

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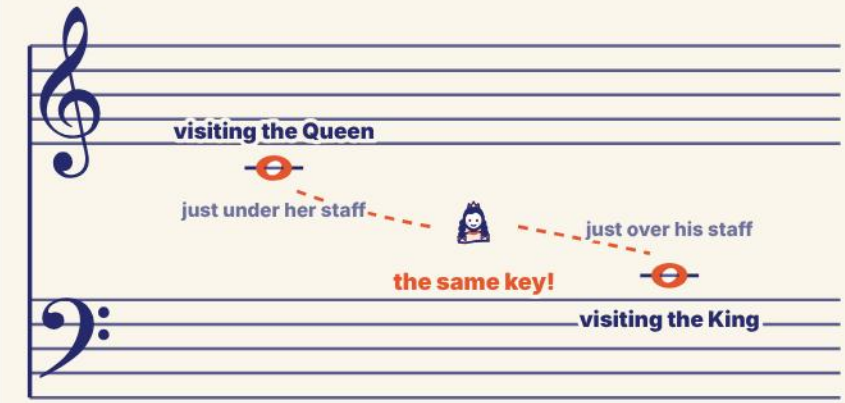
4

NOW (faces)

Step 5

Middle C: Princess Clara

Put the Queen's staff on top and the King's underneath, joined by a line at the start: that is the **grand staff** -- one staff for each hand. Between the two palaces, on **middle C**, lives **Princess Clara** -- the ground from Chapter 2. There is **one Clara**, and she has **one little ladder rung of her own**. **Visiting the Queen**, her note is written just under the Queen's staff; **visiting the King**, just over his. Two places on paper -- **the same key** on the piano.



At the piano

1. Play **middle C**: Clara's place, the one key both hands can reach. ☐
2. **Which palace?** Someone writes Clara's note under the top staff or over the bottom one: attached up or attached down, it is **the same key** -- play middle C each time, with the right hand and with the left. ☐

REMEMBER **Clara lives between the Queen and the King -- the same key on either staff.**

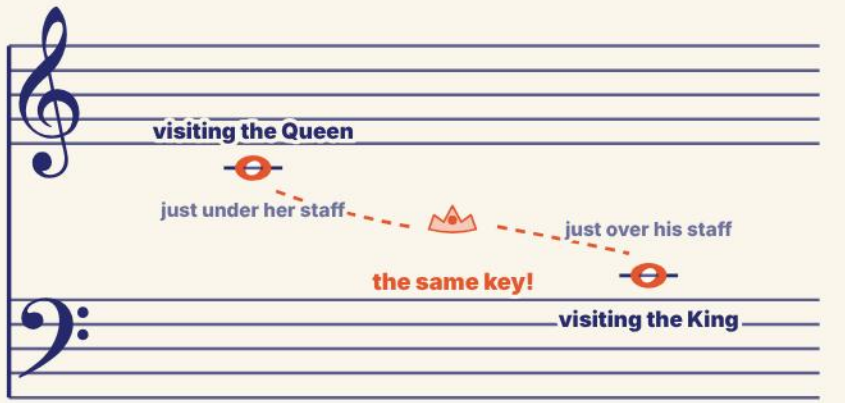
SAMPLE (crowns only)

Piano Butler · Lesson Book Chapter 4 · Reading the Staff

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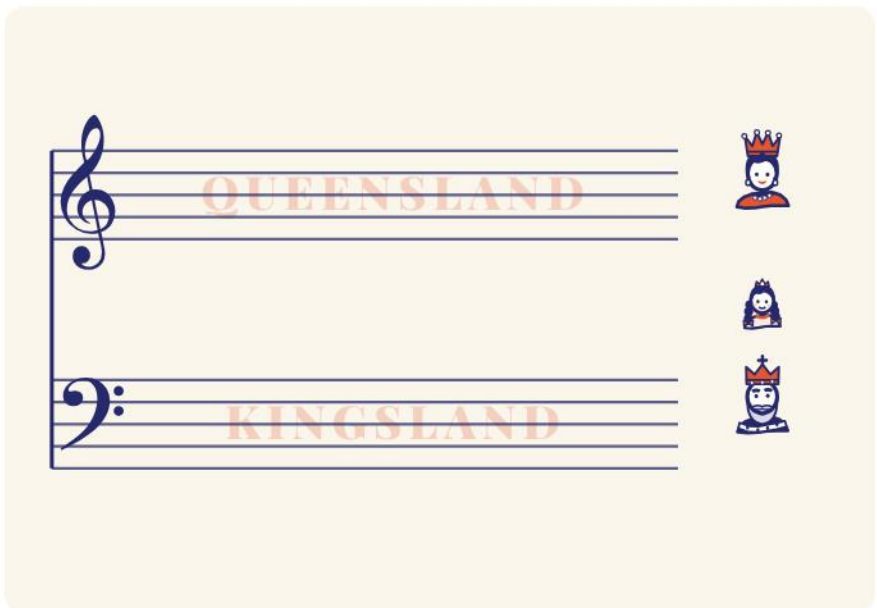
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NOW (faces)

CHAPTER 5

The Whole Staff

The staff is a map of two lands. The top staff is Queensland, the Queen's land; the bottom staff is Kingsland, the King's. In Chapter 4 you read the nine notes around Princess Clara. Now you can read every line and space in both lands.



In this chapter

- Crown check first 2
- Queensland 3
- Kingsland 4
- Fold at Clara's rung 5
- Five landmarks 6
- My five checks 7

By the end, you can

- check the crown before you read
- read every line and space in Queensland
- read every line and space in Kingsland
- find the partner note across the fold
- read fast from five landmarks

online

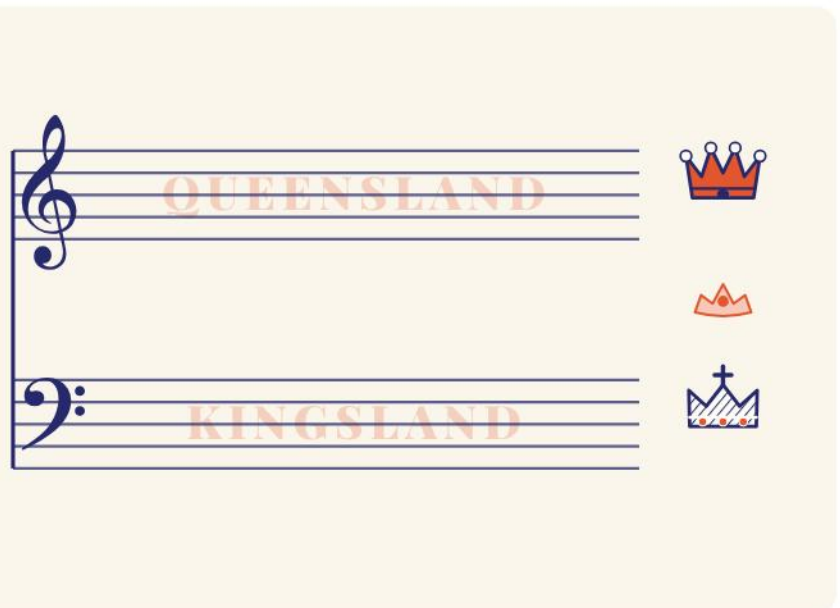
SAMPLE (crowns only)

Piano Butler · Lesson Book Chapter 5 · The Whole Staff

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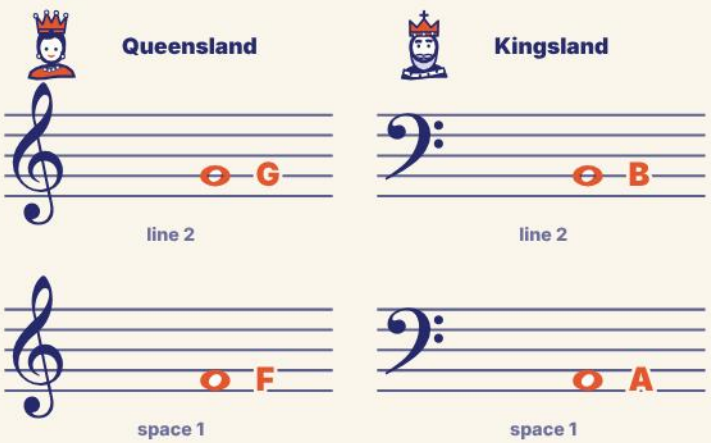
online

NOW (faces)

Step 1

Crown check first

The two lands have the same lines and spaces, but different names. **Line 2** is **G** in Queensland and **B** in Kingsland; **space 1** is **F** in one and **A** in the other. So before you read any note, look at the **crown** at the start of the line -- the clef: the Queen's curl means Queensland, the King's two dots mean Kingsland.



At the piano

1. **Crown check game:** your teacher shows a note card -- call out "Queensland!" or "Kingsland!" before anything else. Then name the note and play it. ☐
2. Same place, two names: play line 2 in both lands -- G with the right hand, B with the left. ☐

REMEMBER **Crown check first: whose land is it?**

SAMPLE (crowns only)

Piano Butler · Lesson Book Chapter 5 · The Whole Staff

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REMEMBER **Crown check first: whose land is it?**

2